and cooperation included quality control, steel projects, the silk industry, the paper and pulp industry, cement and cement products, rural energy systems, small industries development, a manufacturing complex for agricultural and irrigation aids, fumigation centres, rice milling and solvent extraction, and the set up of industrial estates. Maiti also had meetings with President Taraki and his deputy, Amin, who had visited New Delhi earlier that year to attend India's 30th Republic Day ceremonies.

Meanwhile, as India worked in the shadows to lure warlords to counter Pakistan's influence, the relationship between the Soviet Union and Afghanistan took a new turn. A diplomatic dispatch said that around June 1979, Afghanistan began leaning heavily on the Soviet Union and four key agreements were to be signed.

> 1) To establish direct telephone and telegraph links between Kabul and Moscow. Under this agreement a complete wireless station including transmitters, receivers and four-channel telegraphic link was to be set up.

Expenditure for the entire set-up was to be borne by the Soviet Union.

> 2) 'Mutual cooperation' between the Afghan ministry of planning affairs and the Soviet Union's state committee of planning affairs.
>
> 3) The construction of an Afghan-Soviet friendship house in Kabul.
>
> 4) To jointly construct a fifty-three kilometre long gas pipeline from northern Afghanistan to the Soviet border.